

THE LINGO TRAP OF PATRIARCHY:

***FROM SURVEILLANCE
TO SUBJECTIVITY***

Group7

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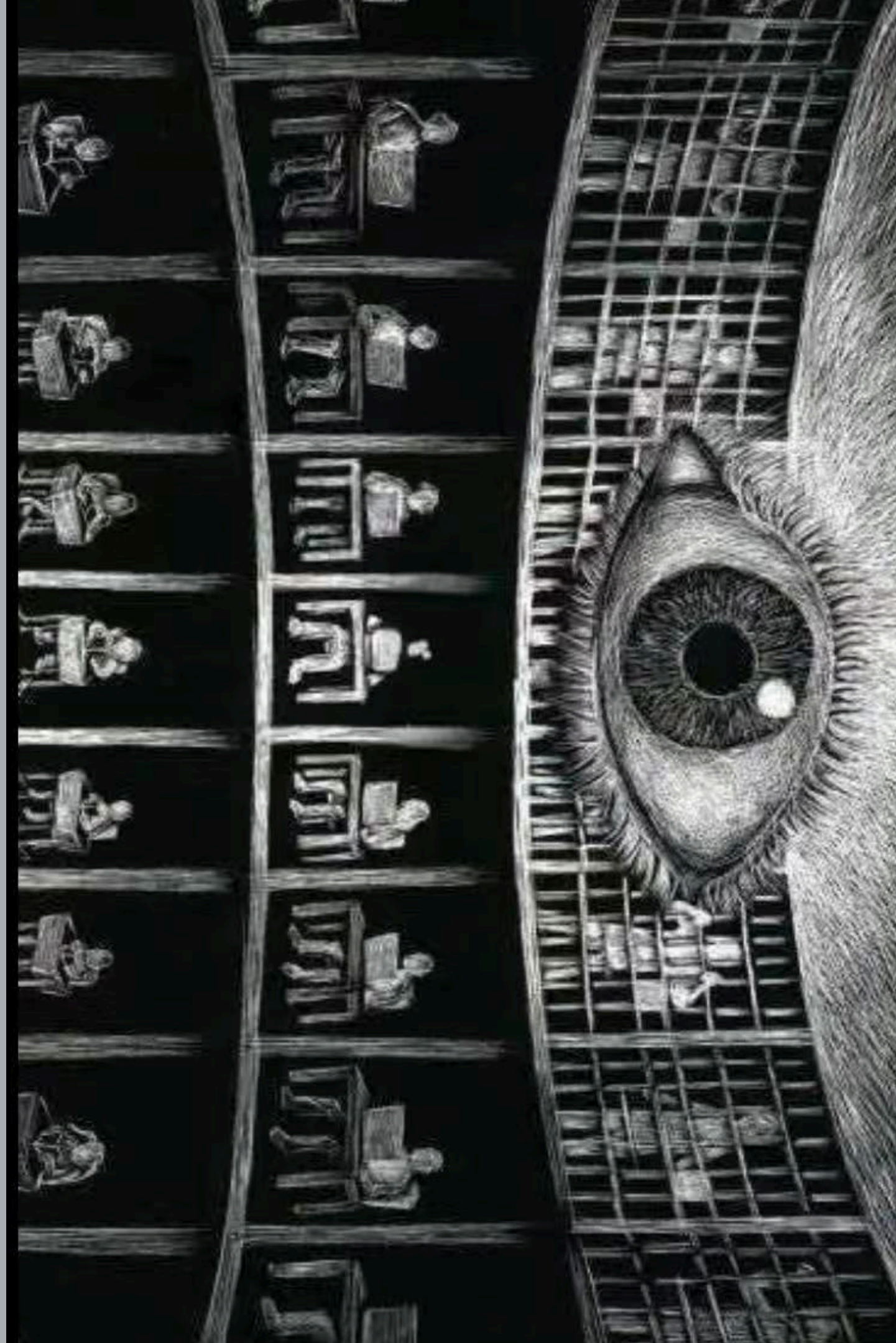
CURATORIAL STATEMENT

The contemporary insistence on 'subjectivity' masks a deeper anxiety: the need for self-assurance has become inseparable from the logic of power. To affirm the self is already to participate in the very structure that authorises domination. 'Subjectivity' no longer signifies liberation from authority but its most intimate reproduction, the internalisation of patriarchal reason as the measure of being.

The gaze functions here not as an act of perception but as a regime of existence. It binds the subject to visibility while concealing its own authority. To gaze is to claim the right to define; to be gazed upon is to be fixed within that claim. Between these poles, the subject emerges as both ruler and captive, sustained by the illusion that autonomy can be wrested from the very system that produces it.

What patriarchy sustains, then, is not merely a gendered hierarchy but a metaphysics: the belief that mastery over the world — over the other, over the self — constitutes meaning. Yet every gesture of affirmation only deepens this dependence. Even the refusal of the gaze, even silence, remains legible within its order.

To critique subjectivity, then, is not to escape its grasp, but to unmask its language, the silent grammar through which power speaks. The question that remains is not how to reclaim the self, but whether thought itself can be disentangled from the patriarchal logic of recognition. What form of being might exist beyond the need to be assured?



The Lingo Trap of Patriarchy: From Surveillance to the Subjectivity

Theoretical Framework

Martin Heidegger – Dasein & Jürgen Habermas – Self-assurance

George Berkeley – Esse est Percipi

Michel Foucault & Jeremy Bentham – Panopticon & Panopticism

Laura Mulvey – Voyeurism and the Male Gaze

Jean-Francois Lyotard – Metanarrative

Jacques Derrida – Différance

How Subjectivity functions?

How Surveillance Works as the Implementation of Subjectivity?

Patriarchy as the Logic of Power

Subjectivity as the Other Countenance of Patriarchy

Reflection on Subjectivity

The Architecture of the Gaze: Surveillance as Subjectivity

Plan of the Panopticon, Logic of Control, Nest 05, Eye Contact

The Patriarchal Mechanism: Power, Gaze, and Representation

Surveillance Bed III, Dragonfly Eyes, How Not to Be Seen: A Fucking Didactic Educational .MOV File

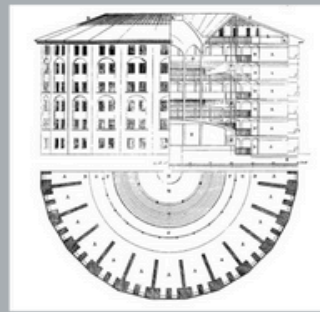
The Dispersed Subject: Reflection, Displacement, and Becoming

One and Three Chairs, A Study of Transference, Family Tree

Exhibition Logic

Artworks

Floor Plan



1. Plan of the Panopticon



6. Dragonfly's Eyes



7. How Not to Be Seen
- A Fucking Didactic
Educational.MOV File



4. Eye Contact



3. Nest 05



8. One and Three Chairs



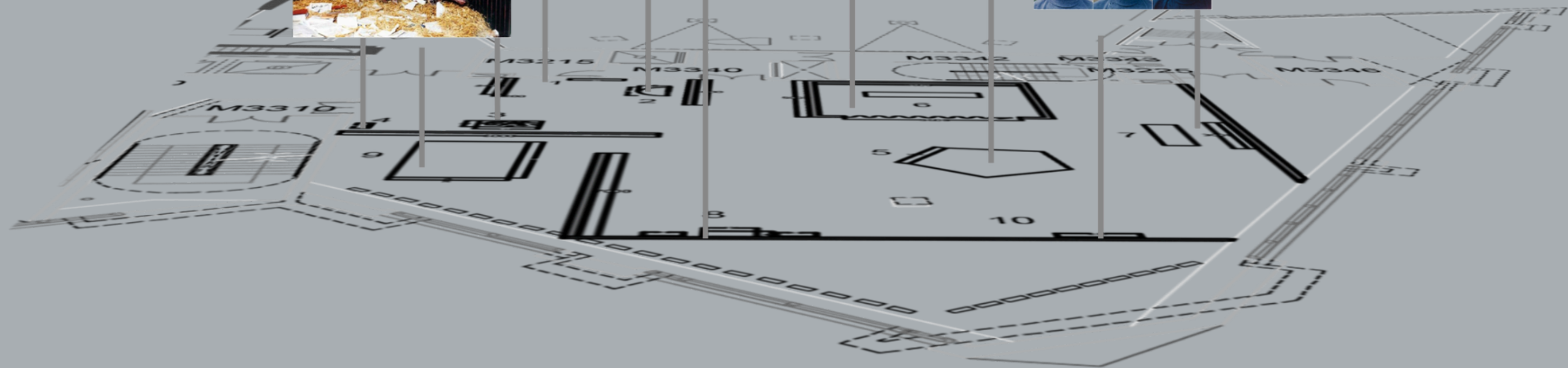
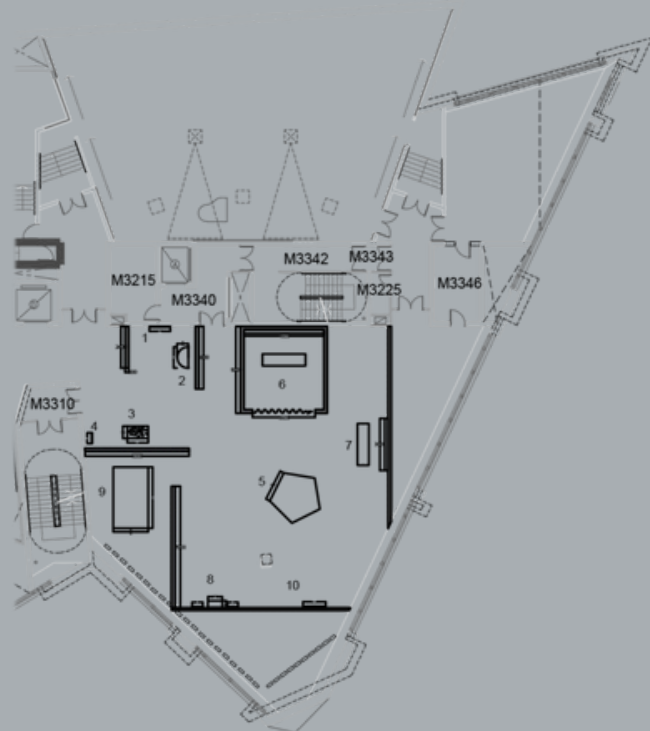
5. Surveillance Bed III



9. A Study of
Transference



10. Family Tree



PLAN OF THE PANOPTICON - 1791

Willey Reveley

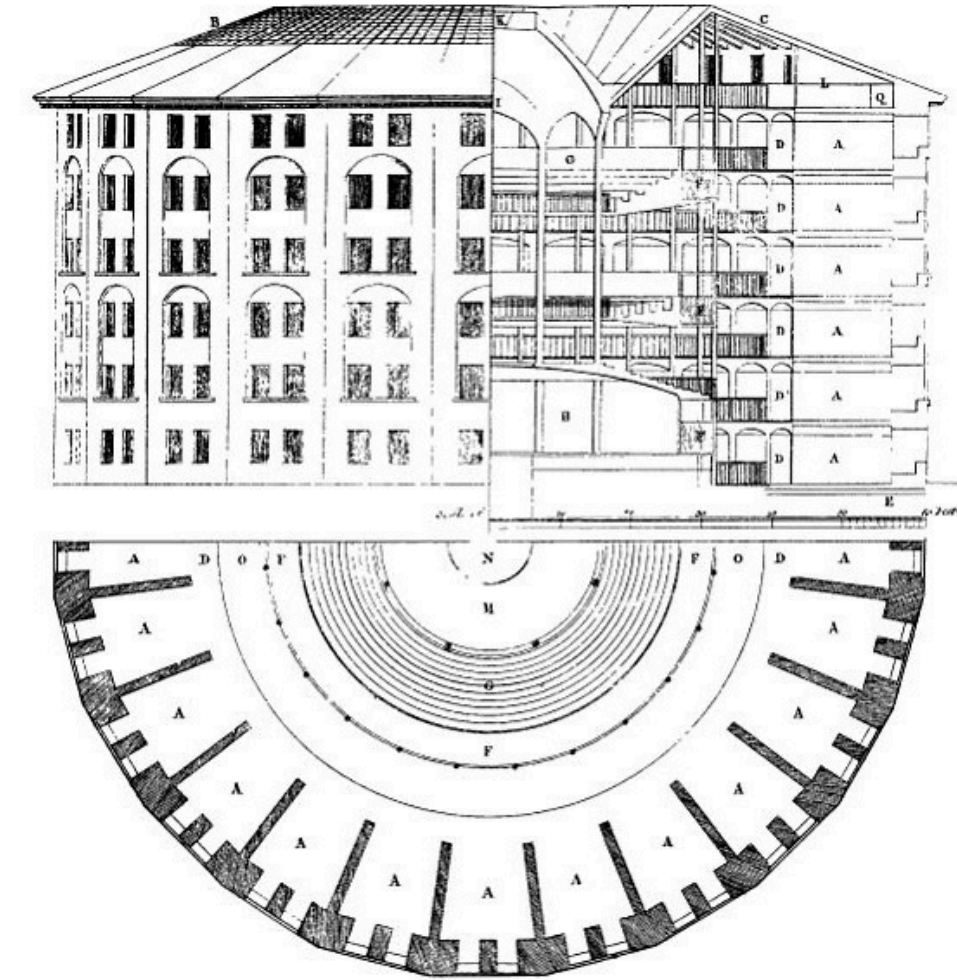
(1760-1799, Newton Underwood)

Illustration

Variable dimensions

Originally conceived by philosopher Jeremy Bentham and rendered by architect Willey Reveley, this architectural drawing visualizes a model of total surveillance: a circular prison with a central observation tower from which one guard can watch all inmates without being seen. The structure transforms visibility into discipline, operating through the anticipation of observation.

Courtesy of The Works of Jeremy Bentham, Vol. 4.



LOGIC OF CONTROL - 2014

David Spriggs

b. 1978, Manchester; currently based in Vancouver, British Columbia

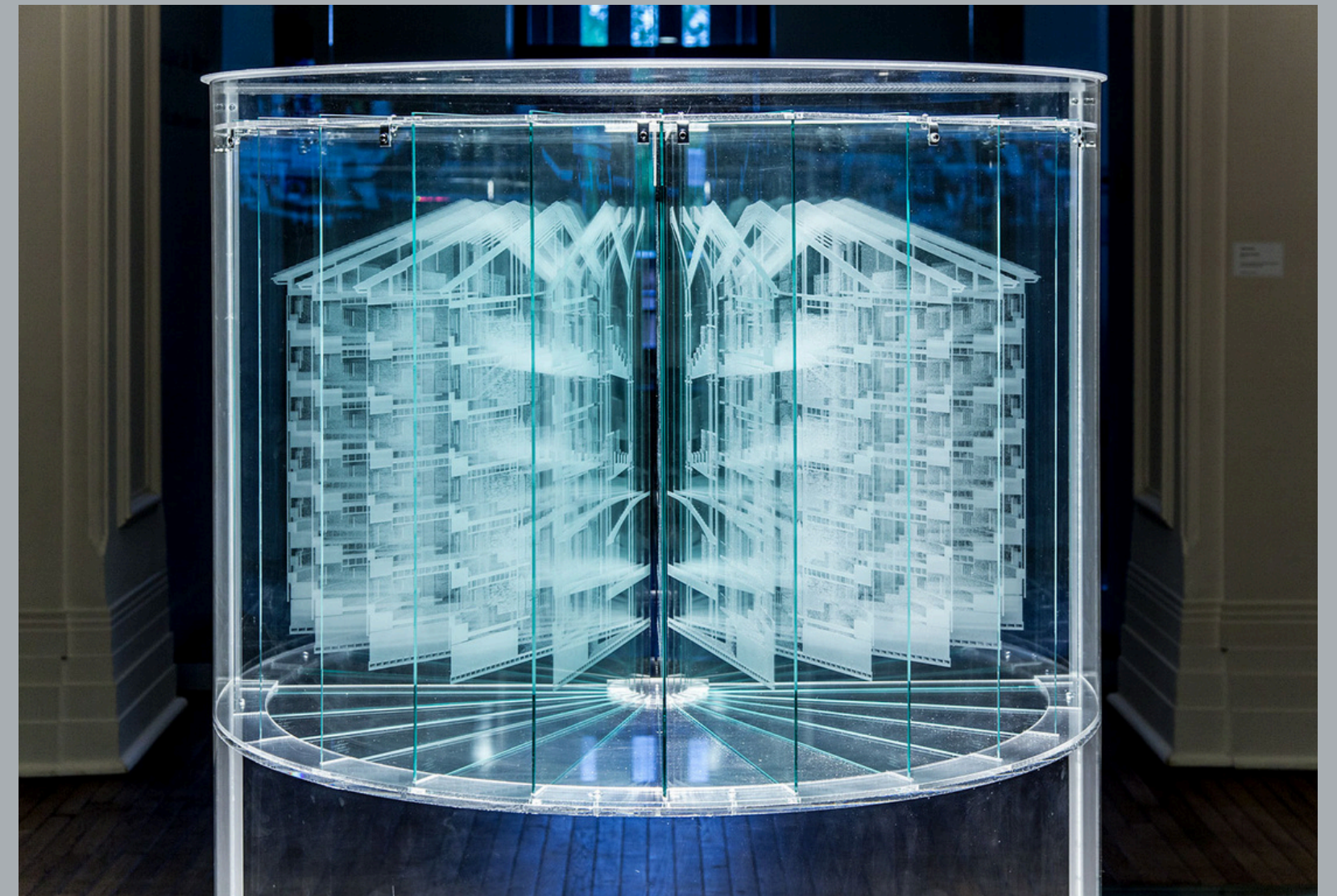
Installation (engraved glass sheets in semi-circular display)

120 × 66 × 158 cm

The forms in Spriggs's work appear suspended in space, composed of fragments painted across multiple layers of transparent glass or plexiglass. When stacked –sometimes up to 400 layers–they create unique three-dimensional ephemeral structures.

His use of transparency echoes its metaphorical function in state architecture, where clear glass often signals openness and democratic governance. By creating a transparent representation of the Panopticon, *Logic of Control* highlights how visibility itself becomes a tool of political power.

Courtesy of the artist's website.



NEST 05 - 2015

Jakub Geltner

b. 1981, Karlovy Vary; currently based in Prague

Urban space installation (security cameras)

Variable dimensions

More than a dozen security cameras are attached to the edges of ocean rocks, each pointing in a different direction toward the surrounding environment. Geltner assembles clusters of technological and surveillance devices in public spaces, drawing attention to the saturation of monitoring systems in contemporary life.

This iteration displaces these devices into a natural landscape, where their abrupt presence disrupts expectations of safety and neutrality. By inserting the logic of surveillance into nature, the work exposes how deeply embedded monitoring has become in both urban and non-urban environments.

Courtesy of the artist's website.



EYE CONTACT - 2016

Ge Yulu

(b. 1990, Wuhan; based in Beijing)

Performance / Single-channel video

61.3 × 92 cm

Duration: 2 h 14' 52"

2016 (Beijing)

The work consists of over two hours of footage in which the artist stares directly into a public security camera, waiting until the person monitoring it is forced to come out and confront him.

By turning surveillance into an unexpected human interaction, the artist disrupts the technological distance built into monitoring systems. Eye Contact reveals how persistence can break through the invisible barriers imposed by institutional surveillance.

Courtesy of Made in China Journal.



SURVEILLANCE BED II - 2001

Julia Scher

(b. 1954, Hollywood; based in Cologne)

Installation

Approx. 180 × 240 × 180 cm

2000 (Schipper & Krome, Berlin)

This installation features a bed fitted with four cameras and video monitors, each mounted on the bedposts. The cameras capture both live activity on the bed and pre-recorded footage, blending past and present into a continuous loop.

By exposing the intimate space of the bed to constant surveillance, the work blurs the boundaries between voyeurism and exhibitionism, privacy and control. It reflects on the ethical and sexual dimensions of visibility and the uncertain limits of the self.

Courtesy of Esther Schipper Gallery.



DRAGONFLY EYES - 2017

Xu Bing

(b. 1955, Chongqing; based in Beijing and New York)

Video

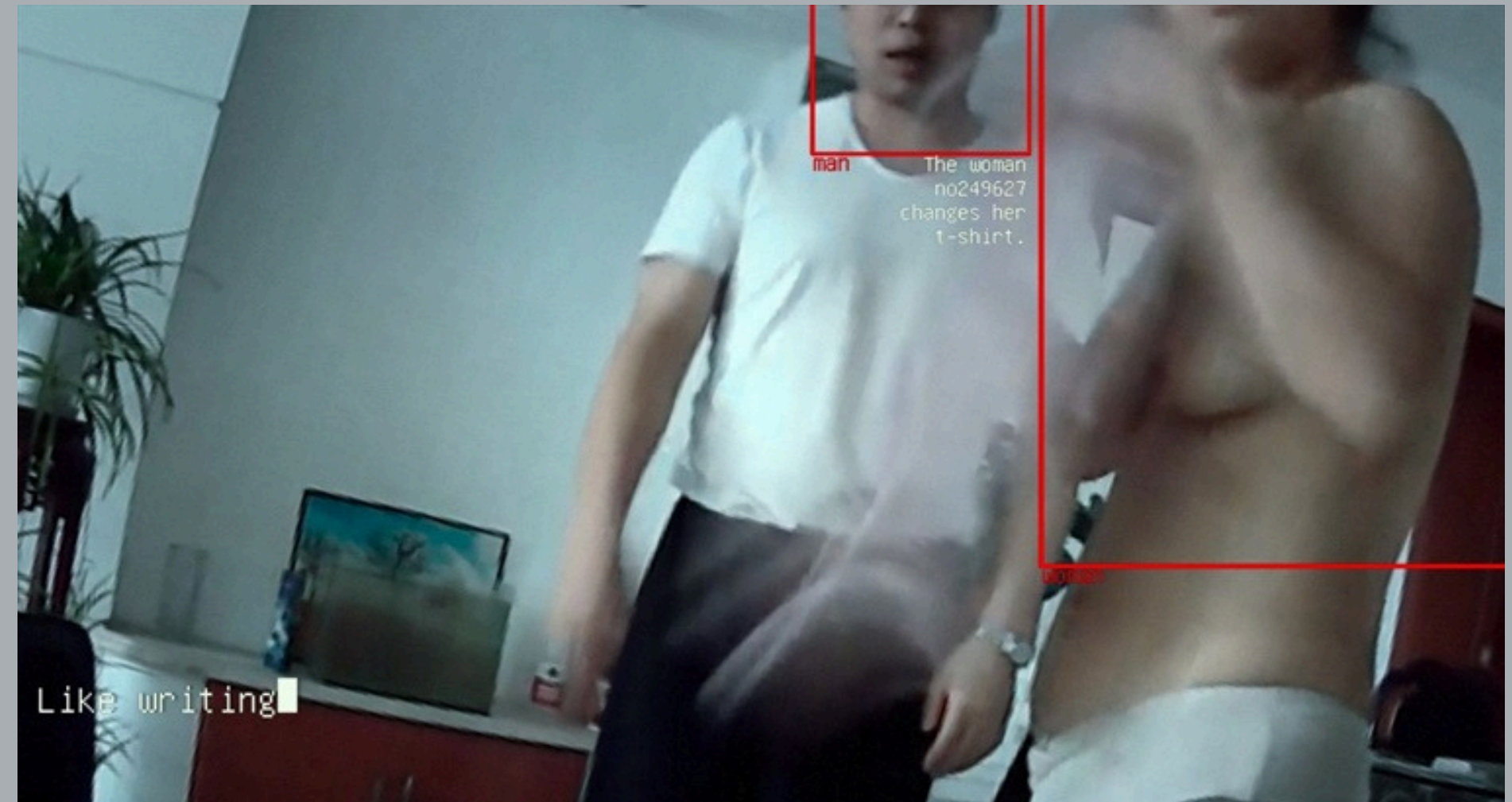
1 h 21'

2017 (Beijing)

Surveillance camera footage taken from public live-streaming websites. With no human agency operating them, surveillance cameras produce fascinating footage round the clock. Ineffably silent, these cameras record incessantly. Sometimes they record images that are beyond logical understanding, captured in one mad, fleeting instant.

In this work, not being seen becomes both an impossibility and a privilege. It asks whether withdrawal from visibility can ever be an act of agency, or whether even invisibility is just another way of being captured by the image.

Courtesy of the artist's website



HOW NOT TO BE SEEN: A FUCKING DIDACTIC EDUCATIONAL.MOV FILE - 2013

Hito Steyerl

(b. 1966, Munich, based in Berlin)

Video (colour, sound)

0 h 14'

2013 (New York)

This video shot on a desert site riddled with photo calibration targets used by the military to hone the focus of airplane cameras. Artist and critic Hito Steyerl's video works explore how images are produced, circulated, and shared. The artist has referred to images as a 'condensation of social forces,' suggesting that through them we can trace the underlying systems of the contemporary world. In this films, Steyerl demonstrates several tongue-in-cheek strategies for remaining 'unseen' in a world subject to new, sophisticated means of surveillance—pointing to the ways in which our technologies encroach on physical experience.

Courtesy of MoMA



ONE AND THREE CHAIRS - 1965

Joseph Kosuth

(b. 1945, Toledo, Ohio, based in New York and Venice)

Installation

Chair 32 3/8 x 14 7/8 x 20 7/8" (82 x 37.8 x 53 cm), photographic panel 36 x 24 1/8" (91.5 x 61.1 cm), text panel 24 x 30" (61 x 76.2 cm)
1965 (New York)

This installation represents one chair in three ways: as a manufactured chair, as a photograph, and as a copy of a dictionary entry for the word 'chair.' The installation is thus composed of an object, an image, and words.

By assembling these three alternative representations, Kosuth turns a simple wooden chair into an object of debate and even consternation, a platform for exploring new meanings.

Courtesy of Esther Schipper Gallery.



A STUDY OF TRANSFERENCE - 1994

Xu Bing

(b. 1955, Chongqing, China, based in Beijing and New York)

Performance, mixed media installation / Ink and live pigs

Variable

1994 (Beijing)

This performance staged with two pigs as the main performers, copulating in the exhibition hall while being observed by the audience.

the pigs remained unfazed, blithely ignoring their human onlookers and pursuing their lovemaking with great gusto. Instead, it was the audience that found themselves in an embarrassing position. What was ultimately revealed was not a sense of discomfort or displacement on the part of the pigs, but rather their limitations and inability to adapt to the human audience.



Courtesy of the artist's website

FAMILY TREE - 2000

Zhang Huan

(b. 1965, Anyang, China, based in Shanghai and New York)

Performance / Photography

frame (each): 131,3 × 105 × 4 cm

2000 M+ Sigg (Hong Kong)

The nine photographs that comprise this work document a performance in which calligraphy was written on the artist's face, eventually entirely obscuring it with black ink. In all nine photographs, Zhang Huan's expression is stern, and his piercing eyes stand out amidst the black ink in the final photograph.

In this work, and in others he developed while living in New York, Zhang reflects on personal and cultural histories, and on his Chinese identity.

Courtesy of M+



Q&A



THANK YOU

